MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation and test-infrastructure engineer with 7 years of experience, including ownership of CI/CD pipelines and ephemeral test environments for three product teams. Hands-on with GitLab CI, Docker, Helm and namespace-level Kubernetes deployments; improved pipeline runtime from 38 to 14 minutes and flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%, while personal projects include Terraform-provisioned Hetzner infrastructure, AWS EC2/S3 fundamentals, and GitOps.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes (namespace-level experience), Helm, k3s, Argo CD, GitLab API
Infrastructure as Code & Automation: Terraform (personal projects), Ansible (basic), Bash, Python
Monitoring & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
Cloud, Networking & TLS: Hetzner VPS (personal project), AWS EC2 and S3 (basic personal learning), Traefik, TLS certificate management with cert-manager
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Other: Linux, Git, Java (test code), SQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wrocław | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering builds, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing; reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage, while monthly CI runner costs fell by approximately 30%.
- Designed and maintained short-lived merge-request environments for the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; deployed Helm charts through GitLab CI to the shared Kubernetes cluster and automated cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity. Platform engineers operate the shared cluster; my scope is namespace-level deployment and test-environment tooling.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests, reducing the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%; built a Python, PostgreSQL and Grafana dashboard using CI results to highlight flaky tests by team, and wrote Bash and Python tools for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Authored the internal CI workflow guide used in team onboarding and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wrocław | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly Java/Selenium regression runs.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Operated a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s environment; deployed applications from Git with Argo CD and configured Prometheus, Grafana and Loki observability, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI results through the GitLab API into PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team; flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1%.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation — exam scheduled for January 2027; not yet certified.